



When Odysseus arrived at the palace claiming he had information about their king, no one suspected a thing. Queen Penelope came to hear what he knew. The disguised Odysseus said, “I met your husband on my travels. You should not worry, because he will be home very soon.”

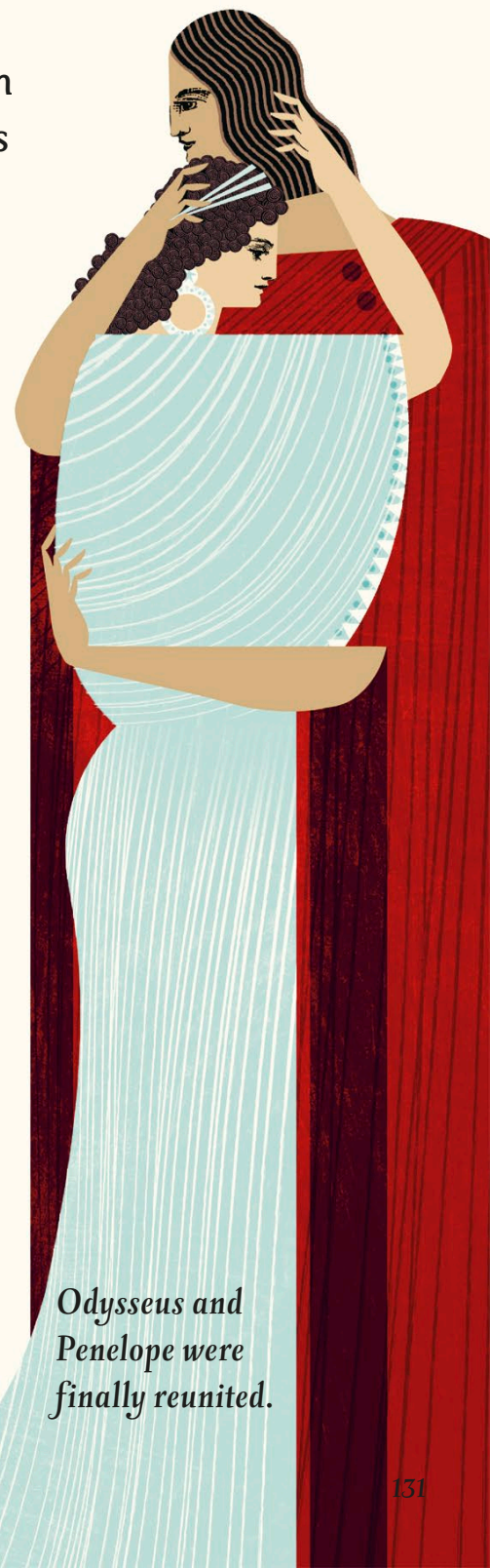
*Penelope burst into tears.*

“The suitors will not wait any longer,” she said. “I’ve been forced to organize a competition to decide whom I will marry. Each suitor must try to string Odysseus’s own bow, and I will wed the one who manages it.”

“Do not worry,” Odysseus the beggar replied, “your true husband will be there to win the contest himself.”

The next day, the suitors gathered in the hall of the palace for the competition. One by one, they attempted to string the bow, but all failed. They laughed when a beggar picked up the bow, but he strung it in one swift movement.

The suitors suddenly realized who the beggar was, but Odysseus wanted revenge. He turned the bow on the suitors, firing arrow after arrow until they were all dead. Victorious, Odysseus then sent for Penelope, and when she entered the hall she finally recognized her husband. She ran to him, overwhelmed by his return. Athena’s spell lifted and before her stood the man she had missed for 20 years.



*Odysseus and Penelope were finally reunited.*